



AFTER

The War with Mexico 1846–48 was generally popular in the South, but split the North and reopened discussions on slavery. The philosopher and writer Henry David Thoreau went to jail rather than pay taxes during the war. Others saw it as part of the nation's Manifest Destiny to occupy the entire continent.

SCHOOL OF WAR



SCOTT'S MEDAL

This war served as the training ground for **future Civil War commanders**, including Winfield Scott, Ulysses S. Grant, and Robert E. Lee (see [Organizing for the Fight](#)). They learned to wage war far from supply lines, command and train soldiers, and participate in operations with the Navy. **Scott was rewarded with a gold medal** from Congress, after his troops occupied Mexico City in September 1847.

NEW BORDERS

In the Treaty of **Guadalupe Hidalgo**, which ended the war on February 2, 1848, the **Americans gained land** including the modern states of Arizona, New Mexico, California, and parts of Colorado, Utah, and Nevada. Apart from some minor issues, **the treaty finalized the borders** of the United States.